AI search visibility checklist: get named when shoppers ask AI what to buy

Shoppers now ask ChatGPT, Perplexity, Gemini and Google's AI answers which product to buy. These answers draw on pages they can read and sources they trust. This checklist covers what you control. It builds on good SEO; it does not replace it.

SEO, AEO, GEO in one line each. SEO: rank in search results. AEO (answer engine optimisation): be the answer in featured snippets and AI answers. GEO (generative engine optimisation): be named and cited by generative AI tools such as ChatGPT and Perplexity.

1. Can AI and search engines read your store?

- [ ] Your robots.txt does not block the search crawlers you want to appear in
- [ ] Key pages load fast on mobile and show their main content without needing a click
- [ ] Product, collection and policy pages are in your sitemap and indexed in Google Search Console

2. Do your pages answer real questions?

- [ ] Each product page states the facts shoppers ask about: size, material, fit, care, delivery and returns
- [ ] You have an FAQ on the product page or a help page that answers the top 10 pre-purchase questions in plain words
- [ ] You have honest comparison or 'which one is right for me' pages for your main product lines
- [ ] Product titles and descriptions use the words customers use, not only internal names

3. Is your data structured and consistent?

- [ ] Product pages carry structured data: Product, Offer (price and stock) and Review or AggregateRating
- [ ] FAQ content is marked up where it is visible on the page
- [ ] Your Google Merchant Center feed matches the prices and stock on your site
- [ ] Brand name, prices and key facts are the same on your site, marketplaces and social profiles

4. Do other sites vouch for you?

- [ ] You collect reviews on at least one independent review site, not only on your own store
- [ ] Your brand appears in relevant 'best of' lists, press or creator content in your category
- [ ] You answer questions about your category where shoppers ask them (forums, communities), without spamming

5. Test and measure every month

- [ ] Ask ChatGPT, Perplexity, Gemini and Google the same 5 buying questions for your category and log who is named
- [ ] Track visits from AI assistants in GA4 (for example referrals from chatgpt.com or perplexity.ai)
- [ ] Note which pages AI answers cite, and improve the pages they skip

Want to know where you stand?

Comment **GEO** or send your store link by DM. We will run the 5-question AI test for your category and send you the results within one working day.

This checklist reflects current practice; AI search tools change how they choose sources often, so re-test monthly rather than relying on a one-off fix.